JAMES RICHARD HAWKINS

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Forward Deployed Engineer with 3 years of experience supporting field teams and managing infrastructure across remote locations. I've spent the last two years working directly with operations teams in challenging environments, troubleshooting systems under pressure and keeping deployments running smoothly. I'm comfortable working independently or as part of a distributed team, with a solid foundation in Linux systems, networking, and infrastructure automation. I enjoy solving problems quickly and learning from how systems behave in the real world.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Forward Deployed Engineer

Apex Systems Ltd

www.apexsystems.co.uk

Manchester, United Kingdom

August 2022 - Present

Deployed and maintained Linux-based infrastructure across 12 remote field locations, conducting weekly health checks and resolving issues within critical timeframes to minimise downtime for customer operations.

Automated routine deployment processes using Ansible and Bash scripts, reducing manual configuration time by approximately 60 percent and decreasing human error in environment setup.

Managed physical hardware provisioning and network configuration at remote sites, including load balancer setup, firewall rule implementation, and troubleshooting connectivity issues for teams operating in austere environments.

Developed comprehensive documentation and runbooks for field support teams with limited technical expertise, enabling faster incident resolution and knowledge transfer across the organisation.

Systems Engineer

TechVault Solutions

www.techvault.io

Manchester, United Kingdom

February 2022 - July 2022

Supported infrastructure migration projects for enterprise clients, managing server provisioning, storage configuration, and DNS management throughout transition phases.

Monitored production systems using Prometheus and Grafana, identified performance bottlenecks, and escalated critical issues to senior engineers with detailed diagnostic reports.

Provided on-call support for two weeks per month, responding to infrastructure alerts and performing emergency system recovery with typical resolution times under two hours.

Collaborated with development teams to troubleshoot application deployment issues and optimise container orchestration within Kubernetes clusters.

Junior Systems Administrator

NetCore Infrastructure

www.netcore.net

Manchester, United Kingdom

May 2021 - January 2022

Managed day-to-day operations of hybrid cloud infrastructure supporting 40 internal and customer-facing applications across AWS and on-premise data centres.

Performed regular patching and security updates on Ubuntu and CentOS servers, maintaining 99.2 percent uptime across production environments.

Assisted with capacity planning and cost optimisation initiatives, resulting in 15 percent reduction in monthly AWS expenditure through reserved instance recommendations and resource consolidation.

Provided technical support to non-technical staff, handling user account provisioning, VPN access requests, and basic troubleshooting via ticketing system.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science in Computer Science

University of Manchester

Manchester, United Kingdom

Graduated June 2021

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Linux Administration: Ubuntu, CentOS, Debian, package management, user and permission management, system hardening

Infrastructure as Code: Ansible, Terraform, Bash scripting

Cloud Platforms: AWS (EC2, S3, VPC, RDS), basic Azure experience

Containerisation: Docker, Docker Compose, Kubernetes basics

Networking: TCP/IP, DNS, VPN, firewall configuration, iptables

Monitoring and Logging: Prometheus, Grafana, ELK Stack basics

Version Control: Git, GitHub

Databases: PostgreSQL, MySQL basic administration

Web Servers: Nginx, Apache configuration and troubleshooting

PUBLIC REPOSITORIES

github.com/jrhawkins/ansible-hardening-playbook - Ansible playbooks for security hardening across Linux distributions with CIS benchmark compliance.

github.com/jrhawkins/remote-deployment-toolkit - Bash and Ansible scripts for automated field deployment and system configuration management.

github.com/jrhawkins/monitoring-stack-docker - Docker Compose configuration for rapid deployment of Prometheus, Grafana and AlertManager monitoring stack.

github.com/jrhawkins/infrastructure-docs-generator - Python tool for automatically generating runbook documentation from infrastructure code annotations.